



Hybrid processes

Manufacturing firms may adapt existing processes or combine two production methods for optimal performance, particularly if they make a wide range of products.

How it works

There are many examples of hybrid processes. One is linked batch flow production, where only two or three pieces of equipment are required and a batch flows from one process to another. This is common in the chemicals and pharmaceuticals industries. For instance, a company may make headache medication and a hay fever remedy in tablet,

capsule, and liquid form, and in varying doses; each batch flows through a series of steps, depending on composition and form, from bulk processing to packaging. Another example is cell manufacturing, which combines job production with flow (mass) production.



NEED TO KNOW

- **Increments** Small steps of gradual improvement over a period of time, rather than breakthrough or transformational change
- **Hybridization** Replacing several separate processes with one single hybrid process

Combining methods

On the classic assembly line, each worker is skilled at producing one type or part of an item. At the other end of the scale, one person completes all stages, creating the finished product from beginning to end. Cell manufacturing combines flow production with job production to create autonomous units. A number of workers are dedicated to production, or part-production, of a set of goods.

